currencies. Someone who wanted to understand American politics had to take into account intersubjective realities like Christianity and CDOs. Increasingly, however, understanding American politics will necessitate understanding inter-computer realities ranging from AI-generated cults and currencies to AI-run political parties and even fully incorporated AIs. The US legal system already recognises corporations as legal persons that possess rights such as freedom of speech. In *Citizens United v. Federal Election Commission* (2010) the US Supreme Court decided that this even protected the right of corporations to make political donations.[52] What would stop AIs from being incorporated and recognised as legal persons with freedom of speech, then lobbying and making political donations to protect and expand AI rights?

For tens of thousands of years, humans dominated planet Earth because we were the only ones capable of creating and sustaining intersubjective entities like corporations, currencies, gods and nations, and using such entities to organize large-scale cooperation. Now computers may acquire comparable abilities.

This isn't necessarily bad news. If computers lacked connectivity and creativity, they would not be very useful. We increasingly rely on computers to manage our money, drive our vehicles, reduce pollution and discover new medicines, precisely because computers can directly communicate with one another, spot patterns where we can't and construct models that might never occur to us. The problem we face is not how to deprive computers of all creative agency, but rather how to steer their creativity in the right direction. It is the same problem we have always had with human creativity. The intersubjective entities invented by humans were the basis for all the achievements of human civilisation, but they occasionally led to crusades, jihads and witch hunts. The inter-computer entities will probably be the basis for future civilisations, but the fact that computers collect empirical data and use mathematics to analyse it doesn't mean they cannot launch their own witch hunts.

THE NEW WITCHES

In early modern Europe, an elaborate information network analysed a huge amount of data about crimes, illnesses and disasters and reached the